

Write Files

Writing To A File Within A Python Program

In order to write to a file, we use `file.write(str)`. This method writes a string to a file. Method `write` works like Python's `print` function, except that it does not add a newline character.

File dialogs

Module `tkinter` has a submodule called `filedialog`. We import it like this:

```
import tkinter.filedialog
```

Function `askopenfilename` asks the user to select a file to open:

```
tkinter.filedialog.askopenfilename()
```

This function returns the full path to the file, so we can use that when we call function `open` to open that file.

```
from_filename = tkinter.filedialog.askopenfilename()
```

Function `asksaveasfilename` asks the user to select a file to save to, and provides a warning if the file already exists.

```
to_filename = tkinter.filedialog.asksaveasfilename()
```

Example

Below is a program that copies a file, but puts "copy" as the first line of the copied file.

In order to prompt a user for a file.

Now we can open the file we want to read from and get the contents:

```
from_file = open(from_filename, 'r')
contents = from_file.read()
from_file.close()
```

And we can open the file we want to write to and write the contents:

```
to_file = open(to_filename, 'w')
to_file.write('Copy\n') # We have to add the newline ourselves.
to_file.write(contents) # Now write the contents of the file.
to_file.close()
```

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